

Teaching Note

Product & Consumer Behaviour

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Overview

The product and Consumer Behaviour simulation provides a comprehensive and inclusive learning experience, catering to a diverse audience ranging from undergraduate and postgraduate students to individuals undergoing corporate training. Tailored for courses focused on college preparedness, business fundamentals, and onboarding freshers, this simulation adopts a consumer-centric approach. The versatility of this simulation makes it a valuable tool for enhancing both theoretical knowledge and practical skills in various educational and professional settings. This guide for instructors addresses technical elements of the platform, encompassing decision areas. It also includes a detailed teaching note containing an optimal solution and a recommended sequence for debriefing. This equips the instructor to effectively facilitate the session with maximum comprehensiveness.

Scenario

The Consumer Behaviour Micro Simulation is centred around a scenario where a gaming company decides to shift its focus from console games to mobile games due to evolving consumer expectations and the availability of cost-effective mobile data. Consultants are brought in to analyse consumer Behaviour models and help develop a successful mobile game. The company's objective is to achieve a market share of over 7% and attract paying consumers in the competitive mobile gaming landscape. To accomplish this goal, the consultants need to consider several factors, such as the demographics of the target population, social elements, lifestyle preferences, situational context, market trends, and revenue models. By thoroughly examining and incorporating these factors, the consultants can propose a tailored mobile game that meets the desires of the target audience, enhancing the likelihood of success and profitability.

Objectives

Microsimulation's focus is on developing successful products from the consumer's perspective. Participants will gain a holistic understanding of product development, considering demographics, social elements, and lifestyle preferences. The simulation covers revenue strategies based on market analysis and explores consumer Behaviour, including motivation, cues, responses, and reinforcement. This comprehensive experience equips participants to make informed decisions and create consumer-centric products that resonate with their target audience in the real market.

Game Arena

The major sections under the game arena includes:

- a. **Introduction:** This section provides an overview of how the entire simulation works and the steps to follow.
 - b. **Market:** Serving as a critical section, it functions as a vital repository of details, providing insights into the company's objectives, strategic methodology, and the dynamic trends in the market.
 - c. **Information Search:** Within this section, participants access a comprehensive market report offering invaluable insights into market dynamics.
 - d. **Target:** In this section, participants make decisions on the target market.
 - e. **Conceptualizing:** In this section, participants make decisions that aim at designing the product with suitable situational and lifestyle elements.
 - f. **Crafting:** In this section, participants make decisions on how to reach the target audience by crafting communication strategy and monetization decisions.
 - g. **Decision Checklist:** In this section, participants can review the decisions and submit the decisions.
 - h. **Report:** This section contains the results of the simulation.
 - i. **Synopsis:** Contains the summary of the decisions took by the participant for the round.
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Critical Parameters

Food For Thought: This segment provides crucial aspects to consider, offering valuable insights for decision-making.

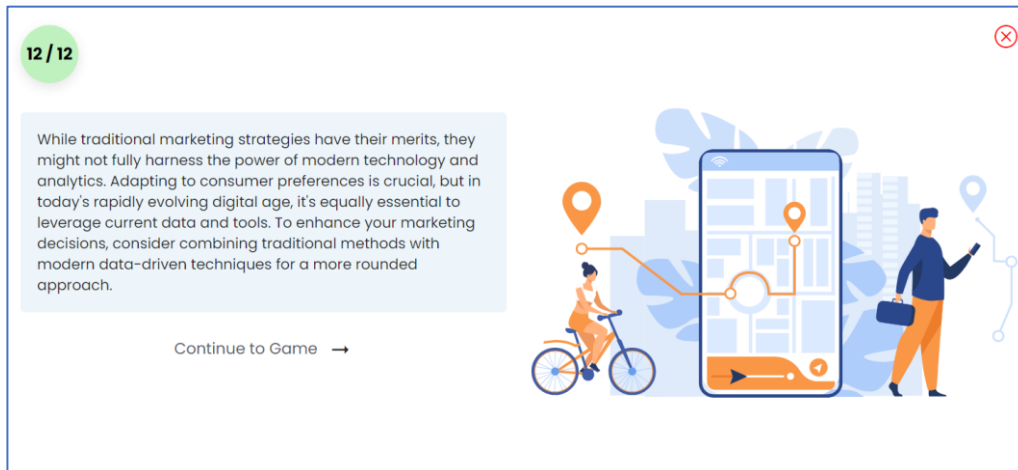


Figure showing the food for thought section in the platform

Market: The market section serves as a critical repository of information, shedding light on Nero Gaming's ambitious goals, strategic approach, and the ever-evolving trends within the Indian mobile gaming landscape. With a firm commitment to understanding the intricacies of Indian gamers' behaviour, the company seeks to carve a niche in this dynamic market. As the company navigates the complexities of the gaming ecosystem involving developers, publishers, and ad networks, the section acts as a compass, guiding readers through the competitive terrain. Anchored by a substantial revenue of USD 240K, an 8 to 12-month game development timeline, and a noteworthy marketing budget of USD 100K, Nero's market strategy reflects a calculated and determined approach aimed at making a lasting impact in the burgeoning Indian mobile gaming sector.

Information Search: Within this section, participants access a comprehensive market report offering invaluable insights into market dynamics. It encompasses genre preferences among diverse consumer segments, details on communication channels, and the most popular activities engaged in by distinct consumer profiles. Additionally, the report provides data on monetization strategies and various publishing options. This information forms the foundation for informed decision-making as participants progress in the simulation, equipping them with essential knowledge to navigate and strategize effectively.

Major Decision Areas

Stage 1 – Target Market

Participants need to make decisions concerning the target market, considering aspects like demographics, language preferences, and income. Considerations should consider population size, financial capacity, and insights derived from market research. The decision lies in choosing between a broad approach targeting a larger audience with lower financial capacity or a more focused strategy targeting a specific market with higher paying customers.

a. Demographic

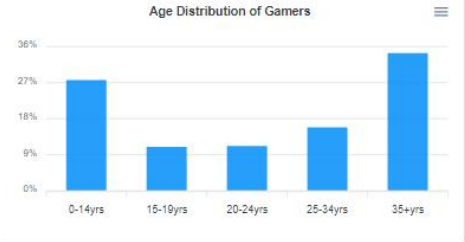
The various decision under demographic includes decision on the age group, gamers population between metro or non-metro, and the population division.

Demographic ⓘ


15-24 yrs
☐


25-34 yrs
☒


35+ yrs
☐

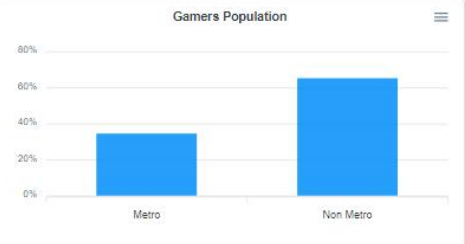


Age Group	Percentage
0-14yrs	27%
15-19yrs	9%
20-24yrs	9%
25-34yrs	18%
35+yrs	36%


Metro
☒


Non Metro
☐


Both
☐

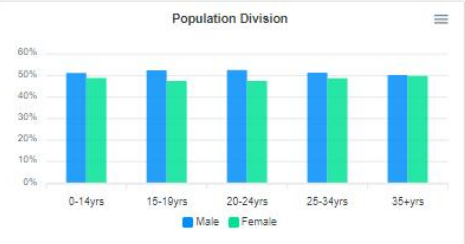


Area	Percentage
Metro	36%
Non Metro	64%


Male
☐


Female
☒


Both
☐



Age Group	Male (%)	Female (%)
0-14yrs	50%	50%
15-19yrs	50%	50%
20-24yrs	50%	50%
25-34yrs	50%	50%
35+yrs	50%	50%

Figure representing Target Market Demographics Decision area in the simulation

b. Language

Participant can choose multiple languages (up to 4) in the mobile game to attract consumers and enhance user understanding or comprehension as well as making the proposition more attractive to the customers. Consider the population indication provided in the graph and align it with the chosen target market strategy.



Figure representing Target Market Language Decision area in the simulation

c. Income

Participants have the option to concentrate on a particular target market using the NCCS classification data given where NCCS stands for New Consumer Classification System that is used to classify households in India based on two variables such as educational qualification of the CWE (Chief Wage Earner) and number of households possessed from a predefined list. The available choices include NCCS A, NCCS B, and NCCS C/D/E categories, each with varying paying capacities C/D/E represents the mass market segment.

If the aim is to enhance the customer segment through mass marketing, one can opt for the NCCS C/D/E category. On the other hand, selecting NCCS A or NCCS B targets may result in a higher number of paying consumers but a potentially smaller customer segment.

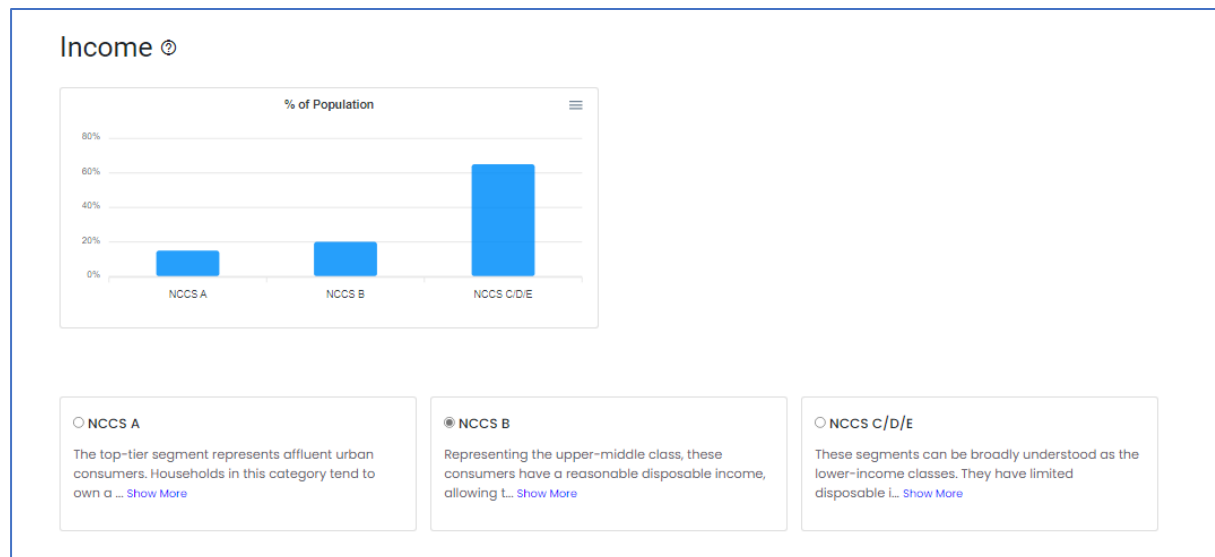


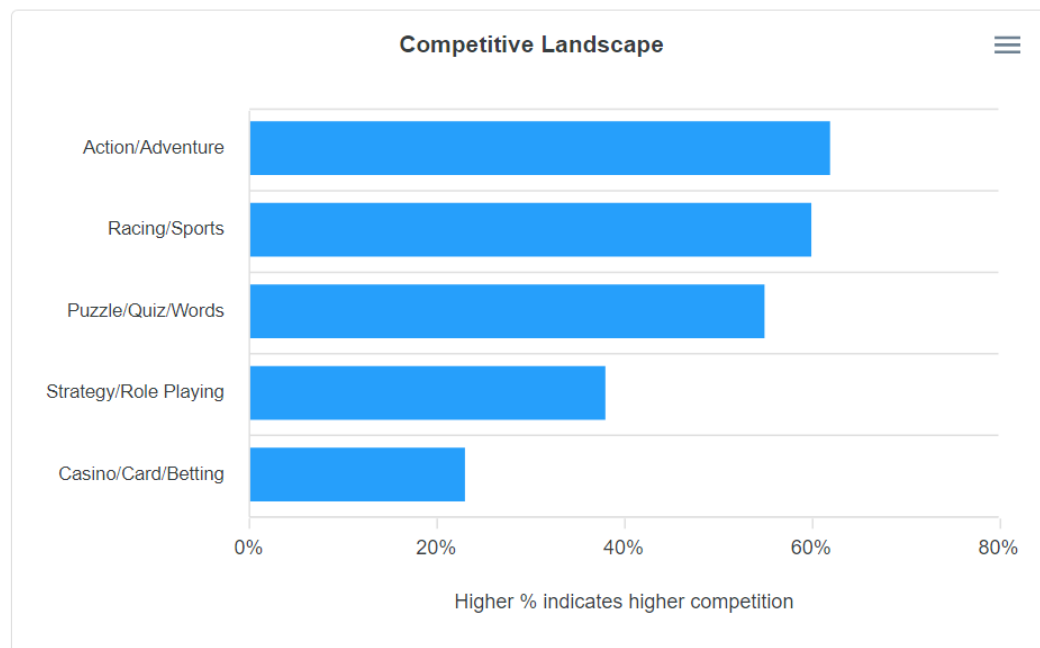
Figure representing Target Market Income Decision area in the simulation

Stage 2 - Conceptualizing

a. Product Genre

Selecting the appropriate gaming product genre involves a strategic approach that considers factors such as age group, gender cohort, metro or non-metro preferences, and competition. It is crucial to ensure that the selected genre resonates with the interests of the specified target audience. Conducting a thorough competitive analysis is vital for identifying opportunities and positioning the gaming product effectively.

Genre ?



Action/Adventure

This genre involves dynamic gameplay, often requiring players to overcome challenges using skills. [Show More](#)

Racing/Sports

These games simulate real-world sports or racing experiences, often emphasizing speed, competition, ... [Show More](#)

Puzzle/Quiz/Words

These games test players' intelligence, problem-solving abilities, and knowledge. They have an evide... [Show More](#)

Strategy/Role Playing

Involving tactical gameplay, decision-making, and often long-term planning, these games witness a fa... [Show More](#)

Casino/Card/Betting

These games simulate gambling experiences or card games. While the overall preference is lower compa... [Show More](#)

Figure representing game's genre decision area in the simulation

b. Situational Elements

Selecting the correct situational elements for the game, focusing on either gamification, cultural significance, ease of use, or continued motivation to play, is crucial for enhancing immersion and emotional resonance. opt for two of these elements that align with the preferences of the target market, promoting extended engagement and a heightened sense of immersion in the gaming experience

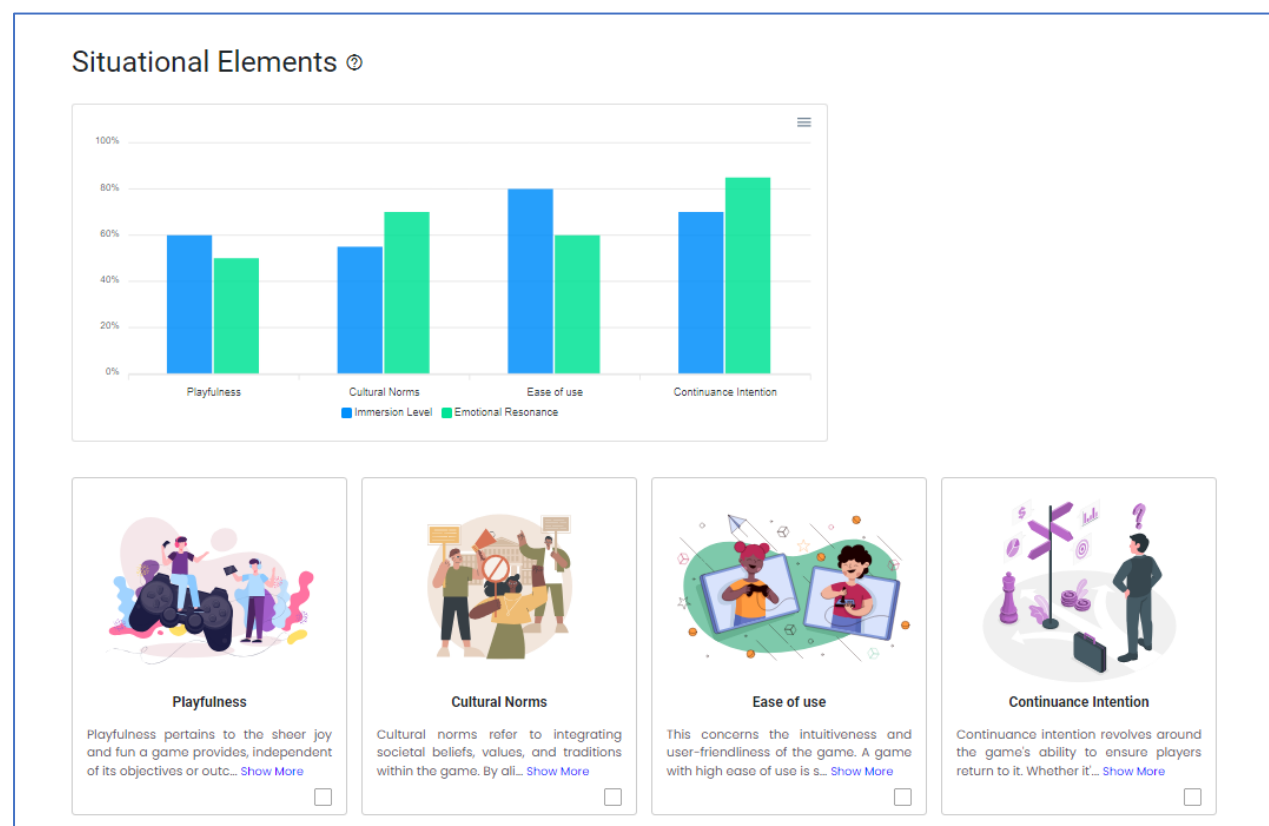


Figure representing game's situational elements decision area in the simulation.

c. Social Elements

Select up to three social features to integrate into the game from options like chat functionality, user trading, leaderboards, push notification feeds, community, and social media integration.

Evaluate the impact of each element on consumer engagement and connection. Ensuring a consistently positive user experience is crucial for establishing lasting connections with the audience.

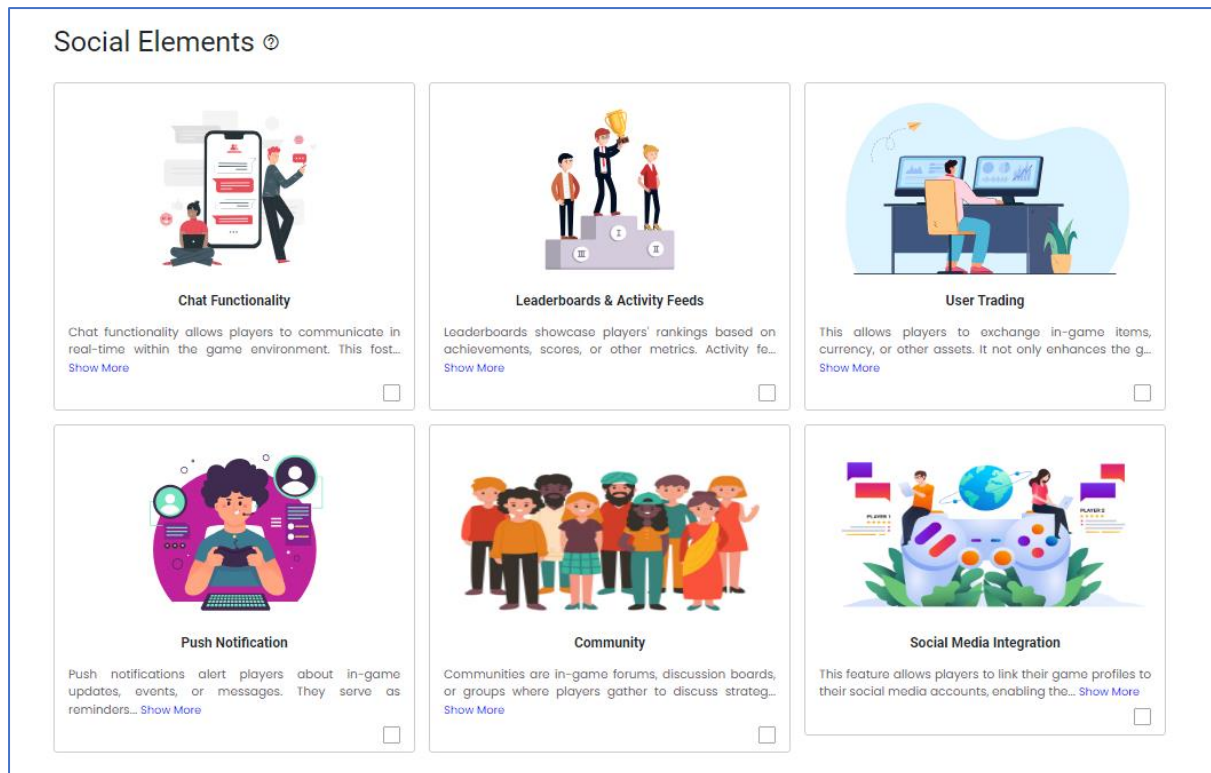


Figure representing game's social elements decision area in the simulation

d. Lifestyle Elements

The selection of lifestyle elements seeks to synchronize the game design with the varied preferences of the target audience, creating a more captivating and personalized interaction within the game. With eight available options, participants are required to choose and integrate a single lifestyle element for the characters or UI/UX of the game. This decision aims to enhance the overall gaming experience by tailoring it to the diverse tastes and preferences of the audience.

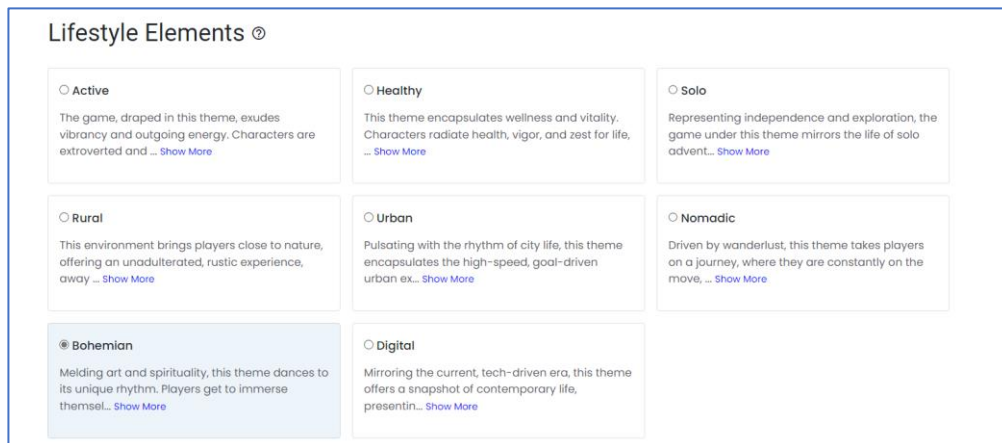


Figure representing game's lifestyle decision area in the simulation.

Stage 3 - Crafting

a. Communication Strategy

Craft a communication strategy for the game and disseminate it across various channels. The participant can choose up to maximum of three channels. The selected channels should be in harmony with the characteristics of the target market and gaming triggers. Ensure that the strategy considers the potential impact on both lifestyle and situational elements, creating a cohesive and tailored approach that resonates effectively with the audience.

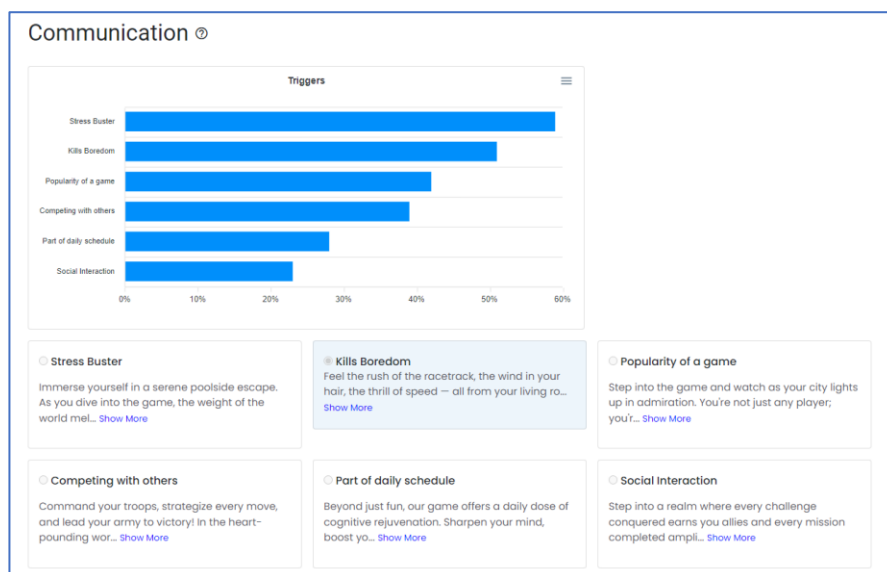


Figure representing communication strategy decision area in the simulation

b. Channel Mix

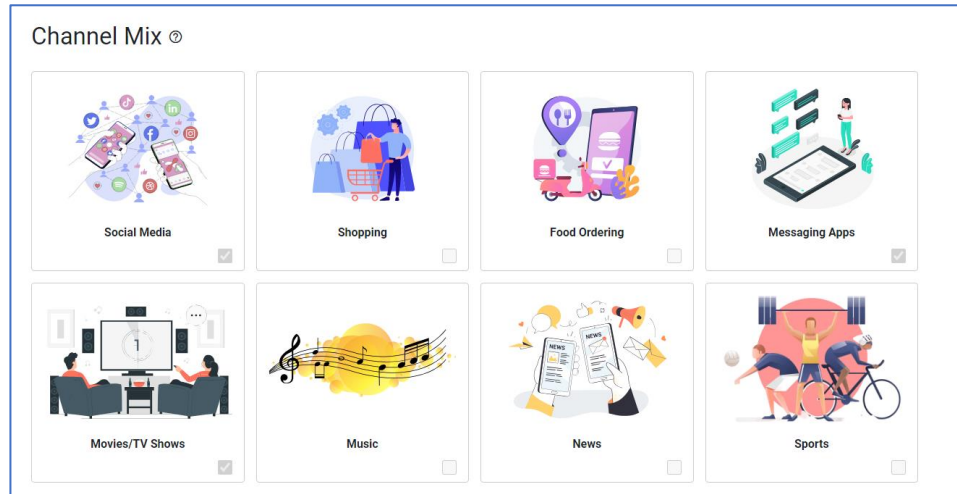


Figure representing Communication Channel Mix decision area in the simulation.

c. Publishing options

The participant faces the decision of either self-publishing the game or opting for a gaming publishing house. Self-publishing offers greater revenue but limited reach, whereas a publisher provides broader reach with revenue sharing. Factors such as revenue sharing, expertise, and the reputation of the publisher should be carefully considered in making this decision.

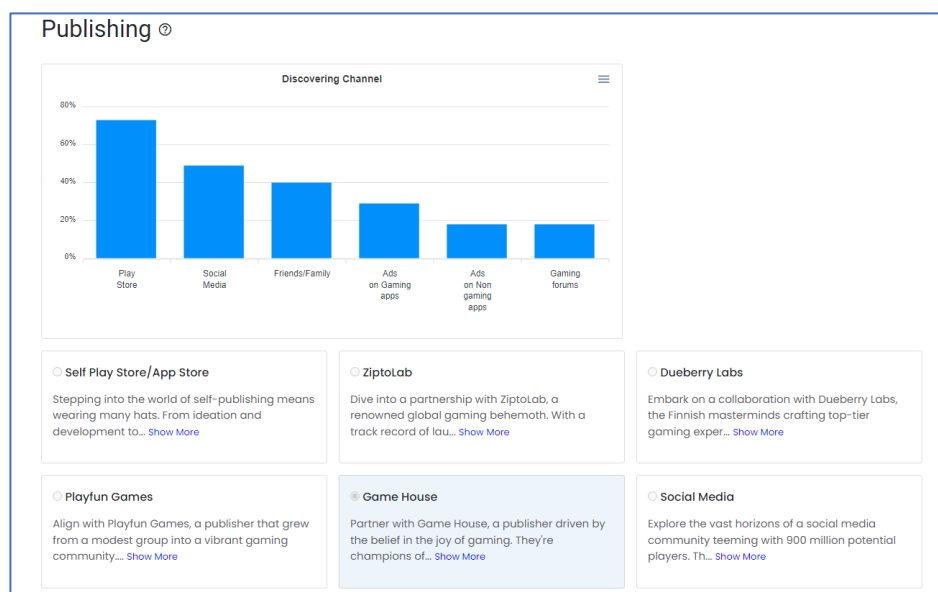


Figure representing game publishing platform decision area in the simulation.

d. Monetization

Generating revenue also involves choosing whether to publish games as free games, freemium games, or pay-to-play games. This decision should be informed by the target audience and their financial capacity, aligning with the goal of attaining substantial revenue for the business.

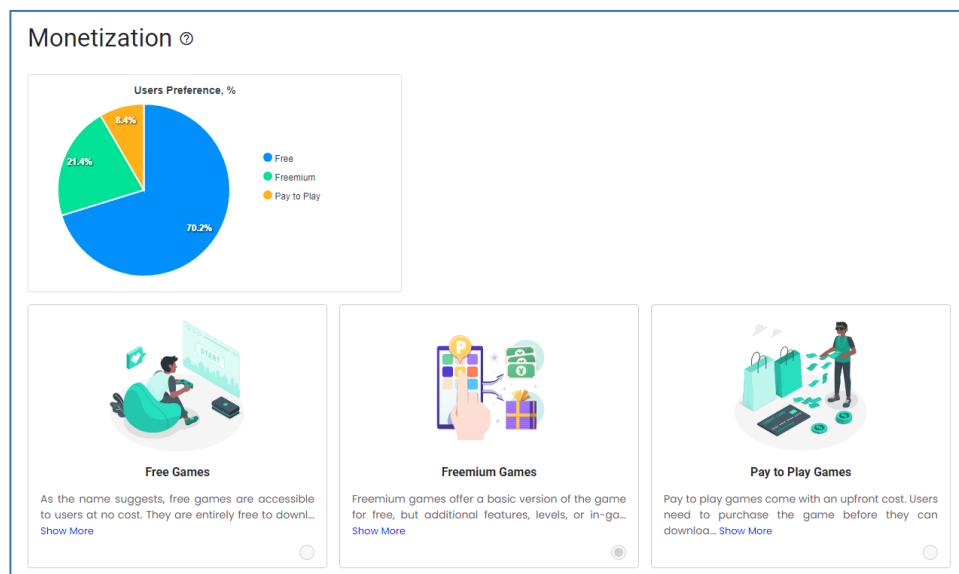


Figure representing game's monetization model decision area in the simulation.

e. In-Game Advertising

Select the optimal method for generating revenue, with a focus on advertisements. Determine the type of ads to be implemented, including options like banner ads, rewarded ads, interstitial ads, interactive ads, or ad networks. When customizing the advertising strategy, it is crucial to align the chosen ad types with the preferences and behaviours of the target market to maximize effectiveness and user satisfaction.

Banner Ads: Banner ads are graphical display ads that typically appear at the top or bottom of a webpage or app screen. Cost-effective, easily noticeable, and can be used for brand awareness. May be less effective for engagement compared to other formats.

Rewarded Ads: Users voluntarily watch ads in exchange for a reward, such as in-app currency, extra lives, or premium content. High engagement as user's opt-in for rewards,

providing a positive user experience. Overuse may lead to user fatigue; it is important to balance rewards and ad frequency.

Interstitial Ads: Full-screen ads that appear at natural transition points, like between levels in a game or during app navigation. Captures full attention due to its immersive nature, suitable for promoting products or content. Users may find them intrusive, so timing and relevance are crucial.

Interactive Ads: Ads that allow users to interact with content, often through gamification or mini tasks. Boosts engagement and user interaction, creating a memorable ad experience. Development may be more complex, and effectiveness depends on the quality of interactivity.

Ad Networks: Connect advertisers with publishers, facilitating the placement of ads across various platforms. Broad reach, efficient targeting, and ease of managing ad campaigns. Ad performance may vary based on the network, and managing relationships with multiple networks can be complex.

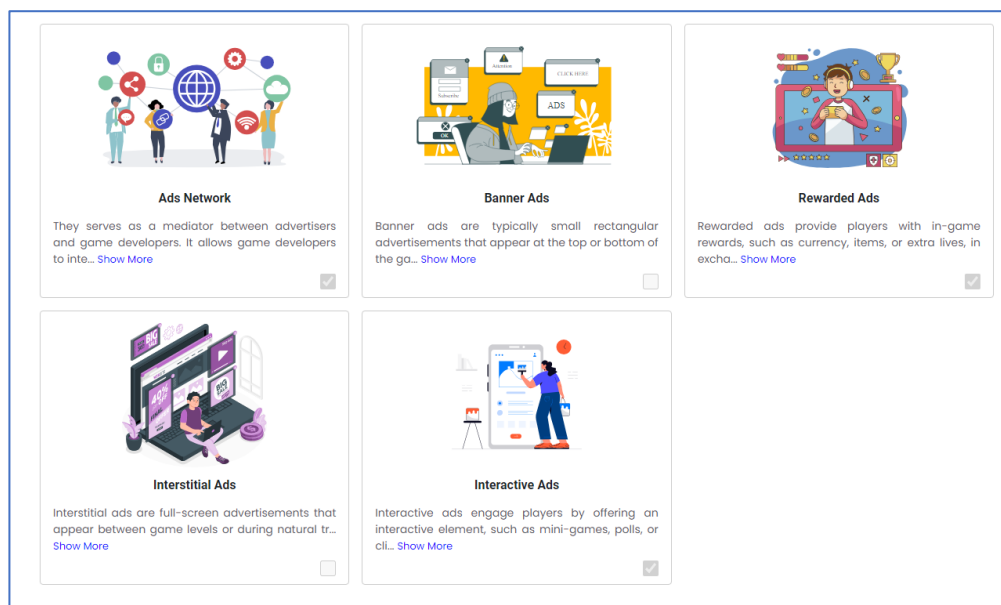


Figure representing advertising channel decision area in the simulation.

Decision Checklist

The decision checklist meticulously outlines the choices made by the participant. If the participant is satisfied with their decisions, they can proceed to the Submit option to save them. It is crucial to note that once decisions are submitted, they cannot be altered. Therefore, participants need to exercise caution and ensure careful consideration before finalizing and submitting their choices.

Decision Checklist

Round 1

Aparna

Target	
Age	25-34yrs
Location	Both
Gender	Male
Income Class	NCCS C/D/E
Language 1	Hindi
Language 2	English
Language 3	Marathi
Language 4	Tamil
Conceptualizing	
Genre	Action/Adventure
Situational Element 1	Cultural Norms
Situational Element 2	Ease of use
Social Element 1	Leaderboards & Activity Feeds
Social Element 2	Community
Social Element 3	Social Media Integration
Lifestyle Element	Bohemian
Crafting	
Communication	Kills Boredom
Channel 1	Social Media
Channel 2	Movies/TV Shows
Channel 3	Messaging Apps
Publishing	Game House
Monetization	Freemium Games
Ads Network	Yes
Banner Ads	No
Rewarded Ads	Yes
Interstitial Ads	No
Interactive Ads	Yes

Submit

Figure Showing the decision checklist in the Simulation

Report Analysis

The report section consists of detailed information on how well the participant took the overall decision in designing the product. This section consists of feedback on the performance of the participant based on four metrics.

- **Rigour:** Consistency throughout the decision-making and recommendation.
- **Structuring:** Logical approach of gathering and analysing information
- **Synthesis:** Approach towards interpreting information and making informed decisions
- **Business Judgement:** Ability to evaluate facts and consider risks and possible implications when making decisions.



Figure Showing the result in the Simulation

Examine the specifics outlined in the report, encompassing target demographics, conceptualization elements, monetization, and communication decisions. These choices directly influence the attainment of market share and the count of paying consumers. It is crucial to meet the market share goal of surpassing 7% to positively leverage network externality effects.

Synopsis

The synopsis section provides a summarized overview of the decision areas, highlighting the effectiveness of your critical thinking abilities in each aspect. It includes information that showcase the extent to which your thought process contributed to the outcomes in each area. This concise presentation offers insights into the impact of your decision-making skills on various aspects of the scenario.

Round 1 XLS

Synopsis

Decisions	
Age	25-34yrs
Location	Both
Gender	Male
Income Class	NCCs C/D/E
Language 1	Hindi
Language 2	English
Language 3	Marathi
Language 4	Tamil
Genre	Action/Adventure
Situational Element 1	Cultural Norms
Situational Element 2	Ease of use
Social Element 1	Leaderboards & Activity Feeds
Social Element 2	Community
Social Element 3	Social Media Integration
Lifestyle Element	Bohemian
Communication	Kills Boredom
Channel 1	Social Media
Channel 2	Movies/TV Shows
Channel 3	Messaging Apps
Publishing	Game House
Monetization	Freemium Games

Market %	
Market Share	5.5
Paying Customers	0.3

Market Units, mn	
Number of users	20 mn
Number of paying customers	0.05 mn

Thinking Ability, %	
Target	100
Conceptualizing	50
Crafting	80

Figure Showing the Synopsis section in the Simulation

One of the sample ideal solutions

It is essential to acknowledge that numerous combinations can lead participants to achieve the desired outcomes, and the provided solution is just one example for faculty reference and not intended for direct communication to students.

Table Summarizing the key decision areas of the Microsimulation

Decision Areas	Input
Target	
Age	15-24yrs
Location	Both
Gender	Both
Income Class (Optional)	NCCS C/D/E
Language 1	Hindi
Language 2	English
Language 3	Bengali
Language 4	Telugu
Conceptualising	
Genre	Action/Adventure
Situational Element 1 (Optional)	Ease of use
Situational Element 2 (Optional)	Continuance Intention
Social Element 1 (Optional)	User Trading
Social Element 2 (Optional)	Community
Social Element 3 (Optional)	Social Media Integration
Lifestyle Element	Bohemian
Crafting	
Communication	Stress Buster
Channel 1	Social Media
Channel 2	Shopping
Channel 3	Movies/TV Shows
Publishing	Publishing: ZiptoLab
Monetization	Free Games
Ads Network (Optional)	Yes
Banner Ads (Optional)	No
Rewarded Ads (Optional)	Yes
Interstitial Ads (Optional)	No
Interactive Ads (Optional)	No

Logic Used for Decision Making

Stage 1 - Target Demographics

- **Age Group and Location:** Targeting the age group of 15-24 years ensures resonance with a tech-savvy demographic, while the broad geographic reach covers both metro and non-metro areas, expanding the user base.
- **Gender and Income Class:** Catering to both genders and considering income classes of NCCS C/D/E promotes inclusivity, broadening the appeal to a diverse audience.
- **Languages:** Four widely spoken languages are selected to extend the reach to a broader audience, enhancing overall appeal.

Stage 2 - Conceptualizing

- **Genre Selection:** Choosing the Action/Adventure genre aligns with the preferences of the target demographic, increasing the likelihood of engagement.
- **Situational and Social Elements:** Incorporating elements like "Ease of use," "Continuance Intention," "User Trading," "Community," and "Social Media Integration" enhances user interaction and fosters a sense of community, promoting user retention.
- **Lifestyle Elements:** The Bohemian theme is chosen to align with the distinctive preferences and characteristics of the target audience, providing an immersive experience that intertwines artistic exploration, spiritual quests, and musical elements.

Stage 3 – Crafting

Communication Strategy and Channels Mix

- Positioning the game as a "Stress Buster" through the communication strategy creates a unique selling proposition, attracting users seeking entertainment and relaxation.

Publishing

- Collaboration with ZiptoLab: Partnering with ZiptoLab for publishing, leverages their expertise, potentially expanding the game's reach through effective marketing and distribution.

Monetization and In- game Advertisement

- Offering the game as "Free Games" increases the initial user base, providing an opportunity for in-game purchases or ad revenue.
- Ads Integration: Leveraging an ads network with rewarded ads balances revenue generation with a positive user experience, ensuring sustained user engagement and increased monetization potential.

Implementation – Methodologies

From our experience, we have seen Professors using two different teaching plan options. Option A is for the one who is pressed on time while option B offers a chance to participants to use the module multiple times and learn from their past decisions.

Option A

To begin, the instructor should introduce the module with the walkthrough video, explaining to the students all the different decision-making points involved in the module and how to connect them with one another (with the use of teaching notes provided by Cesim). The instructor should then provide the opportunity for the students to play the module by themselves. The students can play the module within a team or individually. Once the module is over, the instructor can quickly review the decision-making made by the students along with the results they achieved. The instructor can compare the results of different students across the module and then debrief them while driving a discussion in the class.

1. Introduction (5 minutes)
2. Run Simulation (30 to 35 minutes)
3. Debrief (10 minutes)
4. Conclusion (8 to 10 minutes)

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Option B

To begin, the instructor should introduce the module with the walkthrough video, explaining to the students all the different decision-making points involved in the module and how to connect them with one another (with the use of teaching notes provided by Cesim). The instructor should then provide the opportunity for the students to play the module by themselves. The students can play the module within a team or individually. The instructor should debrief them in short. The instructor should ask the students to play the module again with the same scenario or if they want to change some parameters that can be done. The students again played the module and completed it.

Once the module is complete the instructor can quickly review the decision-making made by the students along with the results, they achieved across the rounds to compare their progress, trends, and approach towards the module. The emphasis of this plan is to let the students play the module multiple times so they can learn from their previous rounds.

The instructors generally ask students to play the module 3 times, whereas the 3rd time is for inculcating concepts.

1. Introduction (5 minutes)
2. Run Simulation (30 to 35 minutes)
3. Debrief (10 minutes)
4. Run Simulation (30 to 35 minutes)
5. Conclusion (8 to 10 minutes)
6. Run Simulation (self-paced at their own time)
7. Short Presentation & Takeaway.

Case Customization

The case can be customized based on the faculty's requirements, providing the flexibility to enable or disable specific decision tabs within each module. Additionally, various parameters, such as market outlook, demand data, investment details, etc., can be adjusted to meet specific needs.

Suggested Debriefing Sequence

I. Overview of Simulation Scenario

- Briefly summarize the scenario involving the gaming company's shift from console to mobile games.
- Highlight the role of consultants in analysing consumer behaviours models to develop a successful mobile game.
- Emphasize the company's objective of achieving a market share exceeding 7% and attracting paying consumers in the competitive mobile gaming landscape.
- Encourage the discussion using any topic specific discussion starters.

Suggested Discussion Starters

1. Can you identify any current trends in consumer Behaviour? How are they different from past trends?
2. How does culture influence consumer Behaviour and purchasing decisions?
3. What role does social media play in shaping consumer Behaviour?
4. How do personal values and beliefs impact consumer choices?
5. What is the role of emotions in consumer decision-making?
6. How do economic factors, such as income and price, impact consumer Behaviour?
7. What are some examples of impulse buying and its effects on consumer Behaviour?
8. How do different generations (e.g., millennials, Gen Z, baby boomers) approach consumer decision-making differently?
9. What is the significance of brand loyalty in consumer Behaviour?
10. How does the availability of information on products and services impact consumer decision-making?
11. How do psychological factors like perception, motivation, and learning influence consumer Behaviour?
12. Can you analyse a successful marketing campaign and its impact on consumer Behaviour?

II. Key Factors for Consideration

- Discuss the importance of demographics in understanding the target population for the mobile game.
- Explore the impact of social elements on consumer behaviours and engagement.
- Analyse lifestyle preferences and their relevance to game design.
- Consider situational context, market trends, and revenue models as crucial factors for success.

III. Tailoring the Mobile Game

- Delve into how consultants can tailor the mobile game to meet the desires of the target audience.
- Discuss the significance of incorporating identified factors into the game design.
- Emphasize the need for a comprehensive understanding of consumer preferences and expectations.

IV. Strategy for Market Share and Profitability

- Outline a strategy for achieving the specified market share goal.
- Discuss methods for attracting paying consumers in a competitive mobile gaming landscape.
- Explore revenue models that align with the identified consumer behaviours and market trends.

V. Lessons Learned and Takeaways

- Encourage participants to reflect on challenges faced during the simulation and the decisions made.
- Discuss the impact of each decision on market share, consumer attraction, and profitability.
- Extract lessons learned that can be applied to real-world scenarios in the gaming industry.

VI. Concepts Covered

- **Market Segmentation:** Understanding and targeting specific demographics to tailor the mobile game. In this context, market segmentation involves identifying distinct groups within the target audience based on factors such as age group, gender cohort, and location preferences.

- Participants should delve into detailed demographic analysis to ensure that the gaming product is customized to resonate with the unique interests and preferences of each identified segment. Discuss how tailoring the mobile game to specific demographics enhances user engagement and increases the likelihood of success in the competitive market.
- **Consumer Behaviour Models**

Engagement Loop Model

The Engagement Loop Model revolves around establishing a perpetual cycle of engagement by comprehending the user's progression within the game. It places a strong emphasis on sustaining interest through a seamless loop involving challenges, rewards, and progression elements. The model recognizes that maintaining a continuous and enjoyable experience is paramount for retaining user engagement and satisfaction.

Application: Game developers can employ the Engagement Loop Model by scrutinizing player interactions to discern crucial engagement points. By strategically incorporating challenges, rewards, and progression elements, developers can craft levels, quests, and incentives that keep players consistently immersed and motivated. Integrating situational, social, and lifestyle elements into the game aligns with this model, further enhancing the overall engagement loop and ensuring a captivating gaming experience.

Player Types (Bartle's Taxonomy)

Description: Developed by Richard Bartle, this model categorizes players into four types – Achievers, Explorers, Socializers, and Killers. Each type has distinct preferences in gameplay, goals, and social interactions. Note that no player fits into one category; rather, most players overlap more than one of them.

- **Killers:** These players enjoy creating chaos and challenging authority by attempting to alter the functioning of the game's world and trying to affect the experience for other players.
- **Achievers:** Their goal is to accumulate status, loot, and points by winning the various battles within in the game; they tend to follow the game's rules (unlike the killers).

- **Explorers:** They want to discover the systems that govern the function of the game world, understand their technicalities and uniqueness's, and learn how to take advantage of them.
- **Socializers:** They want to form connections with other players by telling stories, sharing tactics, and working together within the game.

Application: Tailor game features to cater to different player types. For example, Achievers may appreciate leaderboards and achievements, while Socializers may prefer in-game communication features.

- **Lifestyle Marketing**

Lifestyle marketing approach enhances the game's appeal by offering an experience that goes beyond mere entertainment, catering to the lifestyle preferences of the chosen demographic. This strategy not only aims at attracting the identified audience but also at building a lasting connection that goes beyond the gaming experience, creating a more profound and meaningful engagement with the product.

Application: The Bohemian theme reflects a lifestyle characterized by artistic expression, spiritual exploration, and a connection to music. This choice is strategically aligned with the preferences of the identified demographic. The decision to include this lifestyle element aims to create an immersive gaming experience that goes beyond conventional gameplay, providing players with a journey that aligns with their artistic and spiritual inclinations.

- **Revenue Models**

Revenue models in consumer behaviours play a crucial role in determining how a company generates income from its products or services. The revenue model not only caters to consumer expectations but also facilitates user acquisition, retention, and sustainable monetization.

Application: The significance of revenue models lies in their alignment with consumer expectations, shaping how users perceive the product. Opting for a "Free Games" model, in line with the current trend of free-to-play games, is instrumental in attracting a broad

user base from the outset. Free games not only facilitate effective user acquisition but also enhance retention by allowing users to engage without upfront costs.

Additionally, the inclusion of optional ads presents a monetization avenue, strategically balancing user experience with revenue generation. Revenue models play a pivotal role in meeting consumer preferences, fostering user acquisition, and creating sustainable monetization channels.

- **Competitive Marketing:** competitive marketing is vital for influencing consumer decisions, creating a distinct brand presence, and achieving a favourable position in the market

Application: The competitive marketing in the scenario serves as a multifaceted strategy, ranging from influencing consumer choices to continuous product enhancement, all contributing to the success of the mobile game in a fiercely competitive market.

- ❖ **Influencing Consumer Choices:** The diverse array of options in the mobile gaming market necessitates competitive marketing to influence consumer choices. By showcasing unique features, the marketing efforts aim to make the product more appealing than alternatives.
- ❖ **Brand Differentiation:** Creating a distinctive brand image is essential in setting the mobile game apart from others. Competitive marketing strategies concentrate on emphasizing what makes the game unique, providing reasons for consumers to choose it over similar offerings.
- ❖ **Effective Market Positioning:** Understanding consumer preferences is crucial for effective market positioning. Competitive marketing ensures that the game is strategically positioned to align with the target audience's needs, contributing to its overall success in the market.
- ❖ **Enhanced Market Share and Profitability:** Standing out in a competitive market is directly linked to increased market share and profitability. Competitive marketing, through effective communication of the game's unique value proposition, enables capturing a larger share of the market and generating sustainable revenue.
- ❖ **Continuous Product Improvement:** Competitive marketing involves continuous monitoring of market trends and consumer feedback. This ongoing process facilitates constant improvement in the product, ensuring it remains competitive and adaptable to evolving consumer preferences.

Post-Session Assignment

- The instructor has the option to task participants with composing a reflective note on the strategies and concepts utilized in the simulation and exploring their applicability in the gaming industry.

Suggested Assignment Questions

1. What factors are crucial in strategically selecting a gaming genre, and how does aligning it with the target audience's interests contribute to success in a competitive market?
2. How does the incorporation of situational elements contribute to elevating immersion and emotional resonance?
3. How can incorporating lifestyle elements enhance the overall design and attractiveness of the game? Share your thoughts.
4. Develop a communication strategy for the game, selecting up to three channels for publication. How do these chosen channels align with the target market and gaming triggers, considering impacts on lifestyle and situational elements?
5. Evaluate the decision between self-publishing and using a gaming publishing house. Compare the pros and cons, considering factors like revenue sharing and expertise. Provide a rationale based on the target market and game characteristics.
6. Outline the key principles of user-centric design and explain how they can be applied to enhance the user experience (UX) and user interface (UI) of a new mobile gaming app. Provide examples and potential impacts on user engagement.